Insights Dashboard & Business Recommendations

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Tool Used: Microsoft Power BI
Dataset: Global Superstore

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1. Executive Summary

This analysis evaluates sales performance, profitability, discounts, product sub-categories, and regional performance using the Global Superstore dataset. The Power BI dashboard was developed to identify high-performing areas, loss-making products, and regions requiring management attention.

The overall business generated approximately **12.64M in sales**, **1.47M in profit**, and **25.035K orders**. While Technology is the strongest-performing category, the analysis also identifies significant profitability concerns in the **Tables** sub-category, particularly within the **South region**.

The findings suggest that management should focus on improving pricing and discount decisions for loss-making products, investigate regional profitability issues, and continue expanding stronger categories such as Technology while protecting margins.

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2. Key Business Findings

2.1 Technology is the strongest-performing category

Technology is the leading category in terms of sales and profitability, with a **13.99% profit margin**. It represents an important growth opportunity because it combines strong sales performance with relatively high profitability.

Business implication: Technology should remain a priority category for growth, while management should continue monitoring its margins to ensure that additional sales do not come at the expense of profitability.

2.2 Furniture has the lowest category profit margin

Furniture has the lowest profit margin among the three major categories at **6.94%**.

Although Furniture generates meaningful sales, its lower margin indicates that revenue growth in this category does not necessarily translate into equally strong profitability.

Business implication: Pricing, product costs, and discount levels within Furniture should be reviewed to identify opportunities to improve margins.

2.3 Tables is a significant loss-making sub-category

The Tables sub-category generates approximately **757.04K in sales**, but produces a **-64.08K loss**, resulting in a **-8.46% profit margin**.

The discount analysis also shows Tables as the highest-discounted sub-category among the displayed top six, with an average discount of approximately **0.29**.

This combination of substantial sales, negative profit, and high discounting makes Tables one of the most important areas for corrective action.

Business implication: Increasing sales of Tables without addressing profitability could increase overall losses. The focus should shift from sales volume alone toward profitable sales.

2.4 South region + Tables requires immediate attention

The South region is particularly concerning for Tables. Tables in this region generate approximately **104.89K in sales**, but result in a **-27.01K loss**, corresponding to a **-25.75% profit margin**.

This indicates that the profitability problem is especially severe in this specific category-region combination.

Business implication: Management should investigate the underlying causes, such as pricing, discounting, product costs, shipping costs, or customer/order mix, before increasing sales in this segment.

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3. Actionable Recommendations

Recommendation 1 — Review pricing and discount strategy for Tables

The Tables sub-category should undergo a targeted profitability review because it generates **757.04K in sales but -64.08K in profit**.

Management should:

- Review current selling prices and product costs.
- Identify orders with unusually high discounts.
- Introduce discount limits for low-margin Tables products.
- Test whether smaller discounts can improve profitability without significantly reducing demand.

Expected impact: Reduce losses and improve the profit margin of the Tables sub-category.

Recommendation 2 — Investigate Tables performance in the South region

Tables in the South region show the most concerning profitability result, with **104.89K sales, -27.01K profit, and -25.75% profit margin**.

Management should conduct a deeper review of South-region Tables transactions, focusing on:

- Discount levels
- Selling prices

- Product costs
- Shipping costs
- Order size and customer mix
- Individual products contributing to the losses

Expected impact: Identify the specific drivers of negative profitability and determine whether pricing changes, discount controls, or product-level actions are required.

Recommendation 3 — Expand Technology while protecting margins

Technology is currently the strongest-performing category, with a **13.99% profit margin**. The business should use this strength as an opportunity for profitable growth.

Management should:

- Prioritize high-performing Technology products.
- Identify regions and sub-categories with the strongest margins.
- Maintain disciplined pricing and discount policies.
- Monitor profitability as sales volume increases.

Expected impact: Increase profitable revenue while avoiding unnecessary margin erosion.

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4. Conclusion

The analysis shows that the business has a strong overall sales and profit base, but performance varies significantly across categories, sub-categories, and regions.

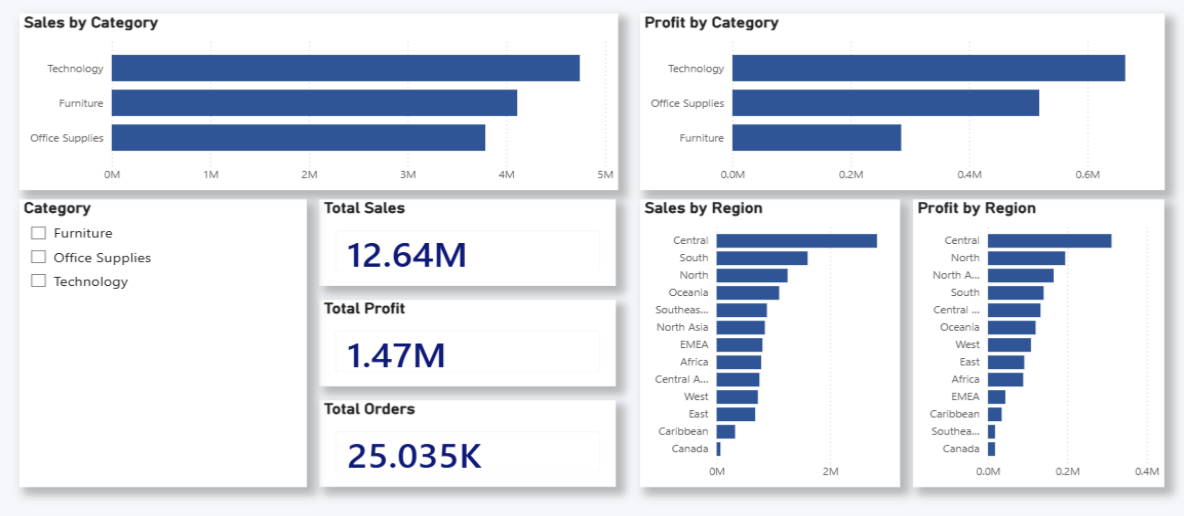
Technology provides the strongest growth opportunity, while **Furniture requires margin improvement**. The most urgent profitability issue is **Tables**, particularly in the **South region**, where sales are accompanied by significant losses.

The recommended approach is therefore to **reduce losses in Tables, investigate the South-region problem at the transaction level, and continue growing Technology while protecting margins**.

These actions would help shift the business focus from revenue growth alone toward **sustainable and profitable growth**.

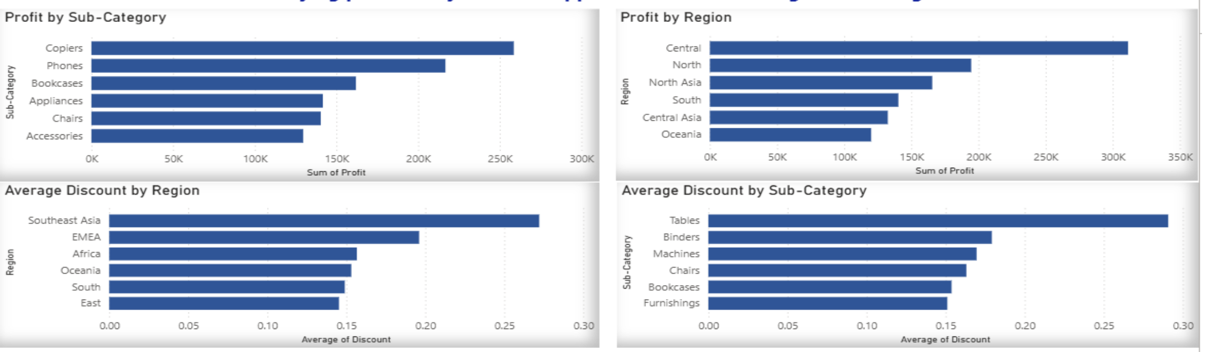
Global Superstore Sales Performance Dashboard

Sales, Profit & Business Insights



Profitability & Discount Analysis

Identifying profitability risks and opportunities across categories and regions



KEY BUSINESS INSIGHTS

- Technology leads performance with **13.99%** profit margin.
- Furniture has the lowest margin at **6.94%**.
- Tables generate **757.04K** sales but **-64.08K** profit.
- South + Tables: **104.89K** sales, **-27.01K** profit.

RECOMMENDATIONS

01 Review pricing and discount strategy for Tables , which generate losses despite meaningful sales.
02 Investigate Tables performance in the South region and identify the causes of negative profitability.
03 Expand high-margin Technology while monitoring profitability.